

188. The expedition of Cyrus was undertaken against the son of this princess, who bore the same name as his father Labynetus,² and was king of the Assyrians. The Great King, when he goes to the wars, is always supplied with provisions carefully prepared at home, and with cattle of his own. Water too from the river Choaspes, which flows by Susa,³ is taken with him for his drink, as that is the only water which the kings of Persia taste.⁴ Wherever he travels, he is attended by a number of four-wheeled cars drawn by mules, in which the Choaspes water, ready boiled for use, and stored in flagons of silver, is moved with him from place to place.

189. Cyrus on his way to Babylon came to the banks of the Gyndes,⁵ a stream which, rising in the Matienian mountains,⁶ runs through the country of the Dardanians,⁷ and empties itself

² Herodotus probably regards this Labynetus as the son of the king mentioned in chap. 74.

³ For a description of the situation and present state of Susa, see note on Book iii. ch. 68. There is no doubt that the Choaspes is the modern *Kerkhah*. (See *Journal of the Geogr. Soc.*, vol. ix. part i. pp. 88, 89.)

⁴ This statement of Herodotus is echoed by various writers (Plutarch, *de Exil.* vol. ii. p. 601, D; Athenæus, *Deipnosoph.* ii. 23, p. 171; Solinus, *Polyhist.* xli. p. 83; Eustath. *ad Dionys. Perieg.* 1073, &c.). Some add to it, that no one but the king (Solin. l. s. c.), or no one but the king and his eldest son (Agathocles, *Fr.* 5), might drink the Choaspes water. What most say of the Choaspes, Strabo reports of the Eulæus (xv. p. 1043), and Pliny (*H. N.* xxxi. 3) mentions both names. But these two writers are probably mistaken in regarding the Eulæus and Choaspes as different rivers. The term Eulæus (Ulai of Daniel) seems to have been applied to the *Kerkhah* from Susa to its junction with the *Karun*. The water of both the *Karun* and the *Kerkhah* is said at the present day to be excellent, and the natives vaunt the superiority of these two rivers over all other streams or springs in the world (*Journal of Geogr. Society*, vol. ix. part i. p. 89).

⁵ The Gyndes is undoubtedly the *Diyálah*, since,—firstly,—there is no other navigable stream after the lower Zab on the road between Sardis and Susa (vide *infra*, v. 52); and secondly, no other river of any consequence could have to be crossed between the mountains and the Tigris on the march from Agbatana to Babylon. Were it not for these circumstances the river *Gangér*, which is actually divided at Mendalli into a multitude of petty streams, and completely absorbed in irrigation, might seem to have a better claim (*Journal of Geogr. Soc.* ut sup. p. 46).

⁶ These Matieni are not to be confounded with the Matieni of Asia Minor, who may have been of the same race (query, Medes? the *d* of Mada passing into *t*, as in *Sauro-matæ*), but were a distinct people. Herodotus seems to assign to these Matieni the whole of the mountain range from the sources of the *Diyálah* near Hamadâr to those of the *Aras* (Araxes) near Erzeroum in Upper Armenia (vide *infra*, ch. 202).

[The term Matieni may perhaps mean simply "mountaineers." The Babylonian word, at any rate, which is used for a mountain may be read as *matu* in the singular, and *matiya* or *matein* in the plural. There is, however, no cognate term in any of the other Semitic languages.—H. C. R.]

⁷ No other writer mentions Dardanians in these parts. It has been proposed to read διὰ Δαραίων, —δι' Ἀρμενίων,—and διὰ Δαρπύων. The only various reading in the MSS. favours the last emendation. It is διαρδανίων, which has all the letters of διὰ Δαρπύων with a single dislocation. The ruins of *Darneh* still exist on the